

FREE RESOURCE FROM OPOUND LLC

8 Tasks Your Dental Front Desk Is Doing That AI Can Handle Today

A practical checklist for dental practice owners and office managers in the greater Seattle area — Bellevue, Redmond, Kirkland, and beyond.

8+

HOURS SAVED PER WEEK

\$3,200

AVG MONTHLY COST OF MANUAL ADMIN

24/7

AI WORKS WHEN YOUR STAFF CAN'T

How to use this checklist: Read each task and check the box if your front desk is currently handling it manually. Every checked box is a direct cost to your practice — in staff time, missed revenue, or patient experience. At the end, count your checks. We'll show you what that's costing you.



01

SCHEDULING & BOOKING

Answering appointment booking calls

Your front desk picks up every call asking 'do you have anything Tuesday afternoon?' — checks the schedule, offers times, confirms, and enters it manually.

■ *Cost: ~2 hrs/day per staff member. Every missed call after hours is a lost patient.*

✓ *AI fix: Checks real-time availability, collects patient details, and delivers a confirmed booking link — at 2am if needed.*



02

AFTER-HOURS & OVERFLOW

Handling calls and inquiries after closing

Voicemails pile up overnight and on weekends. Staff spend the first hour of every morning returning calls from patients who called after 5pm.

■ *Cost: 45–60 min of productive morning time lost daily. Patients who don't get a callback call a competitor.*

✓ *AI fix: Responds instantly after hours, answers common questions, books appointments, and flags urgent cases.*



03

PATIENT INTAKE

Collecting new patient information manually

Front desk staff ask for name, date of birth, insurance, reason for visit — either over the phone or by handing over a clipboard on arrival.

■ *Cost: 8–12 minutes per new patient intake. Creates data entry errors and delays chair time.*

✓ *AI fix: Collects patient details through natural conversation before the appointment, synced directly to your system.*

**04**

INSURANCE QUESTIONS

Answering insurance coverage questions

'Is my Delta Dental PPO accepted?' 'Does my plan cover cleanings twice a year?' These calls come in daily and require staff to look up plan details each time.

■ *Cost: 5–10 min per call. Multiplied by 10+ calls daily, that's over an hour of staff time on repeatable questions.*

✓ *AI fix: Instantly answers common insurance questions from your own coverage documentation, 24/7.*

**05**

REMINDERS & FOLLOW-UP

Sending appointment reminders and handling rescheduling

Staff call or text patients 48 hours before their appointment, log confirmations, and manually reschedule the ones who cancel.

■ *Cost: 30–60 min daily. No-show rate averages 10–15% without reminders — each missed slot costs \$150–\$400.*

✓ *AI fix: Sends automated reminders, handles confirmations, and offers rescheduling — all without staff involvement.*

**06**

PATIENT COMMUNICATION

Answering repetitive FAQ calls and messages

'What are your hours?' 'Where are you located?' 'Do you take walk-ins?' 'How much does a cleaning cost without insurance?' The same 15 questions, answered 20 times a day.

■ *Cost: Low per call, but the volume is high. Interrupts every other task your front desk is trying to complete.*

✓ *AI fix: Handles all standard FAQs instantly via chat or phone, trained on your practice's specific information.*

**07**

CRM & DATA ENTRY

Manually logging patient contacts and conversation notes

After every call or booking, staff enter contact details into your CRM or practice management system — name, phone, email, reason for visit, insurance notes.

■ *Cost: 3–5 min per patient interaction. Prone to errors and often skipped during busy periods, creating gaps in your records.*

✓ *AI fix: Automatically creates or updates patient records and logs conversation summaries after every interaction.*

**08**

MISSED REVENUE

Following up on unbooked inquiries and missed calls

Patients who called but didn't book, left a voicemail that got buried, or asked about a procedure but never scheduled — these leads go cold because no one has time to follow up.

■ *Cost: Industry average is 30–40% of inquiries never convert due to slow or no follow-up. At \$200 avg per appointment, that adds up fast.*

✓ *AI fix: Automatically follows up with unbooked inquiries via text or email within minutes — while your staff focuses on patients in the chair.*

How many did you check?

1–3 checks

Good start. A targeted AI agent could save your team 3–5 hrs/week.

4–6 checks

Significant opportunity. You're likely losing \$1,500–\$2,500/month to manual work.

7–8 checks

Your front desk is overwhelmed. AI can recapture 8+ hrs/week and \$3,000+/month.

Ready to see exactly which AI systems your practice needs?

Book a free AI Readiness Audit. We'll map your workflows, identify your top 3 automation opportunities, and deliver a written 90-day implementation roadmap — in 2 weeks.

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